

22 Local Marketing

(Formerly VicTree Websites LLC)

FREE RESOURCE

THE PHOTO OPTIMIZATION GUIDE

What to shoot on every job and how to make those photos rank | 22 Local Marketing

Photos do two jobs at once: they make customers trust you before they call, and they tell Google your business is real and active. Google's own numbers say businesses with photos on their profile get 42% more direction requests and 35% more website clicks. This guide covers what to shoot on every job, how to set up your Google Business Profile photos, and the small optimization habits that turn a camera roll into rankings.

Rule number one: real photos only. No stock, ever.

Stock photos consistently underperform real ones, both in rankings and in trust. A slightly crooked phone photo of your actual crew beats a polished stock image every time, because customers can tell the difference and so can Google.

PART 1: WHAT TO SHOOT ON EVERY JOB

The habit that matters: 5 minutes of photos per job, every job. Here is the shot list.

- **Before and after, same angle.** Stand in the same spot for both. The pair is the single most convincing image you can put anywhere.
- **The crew at work.** Real people in real gear, faces visible when possible. This is what separates you from every faceless competitor.
- **The equipment.** Bucket truck, crane, chipper, mill. Serious equipment signals a serious operation.
- **Context shots.** Wide frames that show the house, the yard, the street. These carry location signals and feel local because they are.
- **The cleanup.** A spotless lawn after a removal answers the question every homeowner silently asks.

Phone camera basics

- Wipe the lens first. Half of all bad job photos are just a dirty lens.
- Shoot in daylight, keep the sun behind you.
- Hold the phone level and shoot both landscape and portrait versions of your best shots.

- No filters. Natural photos read as honest.
- Leave Location Services on for the camera. This geotags photos automatically, which matters in Part 3.

PART 2: SETTING UP YOUR PROFILE PHOTOS

Before anything else: never delete your existing profile photos. Old photos carry views and engagement that help you. Leave them alone and optimize everything you add from today forward.

PHOTO TYPE	SPEC	WHAT TO USE
Cover photo	1024 x 575 minimum	Your best action shot: crew working, truck on site. This is the image Google shows first.
Logo	720 x 720 minimum	Clean logo on a plain background, so you are recognizable next to your name.
Team	3+ photos	The owner, the crew, group shots. Faces build trust faster than anything else on the profile.
At work	3+ photos	Jobs in progress and finished results. Add to these constantly from Part 1's shot list.
Exterior / equipment	3+ photos	The shop, the yard, the trucks. Proof of a real, established operation.

Every photo must be under 10MB and at least 720 x 720. A profile with 20 or more real photos is the baseline we set for every client; the profiles that win their markets keep climbing well past 100.

PART 3: THE OPTIMIZATION HABITS

Upload rhythm beats upload volume

Two photos a week, every week, outperforms forty photos dumped once a quarter. Upload frequency is an activity signal, the same way review frequency is. Put it on the calendar: every Friday, pick the two best shots from that week's jobs and post them to the profile.

Geotagging

Photos taken on a phone with Location Services on already carry GPS coordinates in the file. Google strips that data after reading it, which means it costs you nothing and can only help. If you upload from a computer, free tools like Geolmgr can write coordinates onto a photo before you post it. Tag the photo where the job actually happened, never anywhere else; faking locations is the kind of shortcut that gets profiles suspended.

Name the file like a human

Before uploading, rename the file from IMG_4823.jpg to something true and descriptive: oak-removal-pueblo-west.jpg. It is a small signal, it takes five seconds, and it stacks up across hundreds of photos.

Bonus: put the same photos to work on your website

Everything above is about your Google Business Profile. The library it builds pays a second time on your website, where the same real photos do the selling. Three habits if you reuse them there:

- Every image gets alt text that describes what is actually in it, service and city included when honest.
- Compress images to modern formats (webp) so pages stay fast. Big raw photos are the number one cause of slow tree service websites.
- Reuse the same real photos across the website, profile, and social pages. Consistency is a trust signal to AI search tools reading all three.

What this looks like in practice

Five minutes of photos on every job using the shot list, two uploads to the profile every Friday, files named honestly, and the same real images feeding the website and socials. Six months of that builds a photo library no competitor can fake.